

Chapter 5

Nursing Process and Critical Thinking

Lesson 5.1: Nursing Process and Critical Thinking

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1. Explain the use of each of the six phases of the nursing process.
2. List the elements of each of the six phases of the nursing process.
3. Describe the establishment of the database.
4. Discuss the components of a patient problem statement.
5. Differentiate between types of health problems.

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6. Describe the development of patient-centered goals.
7. Discuss the creation of nursing orders.
8. Explain the evaluation of a nursing care plan.
9. Demonstrate the nursing process by preparing a nursing care plan.
10. Explain North American Nursing Diagnosis Association International (NANDA-I), *Nursing Interventions Classification (NIC)*, and *Nursing Outcomes Classification (NOC)*.

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11. Describe the use of clinical pathways in managed care.
12. Discuss critical thinking in nursing.
13. Define evidence-based practice.

Introduction

- Nursing defined
- Nursing process
 - Systematic method by which nurses plan and provide care for patients
 - Problem solving
 - Six phases

Six Phases of the Nursing Process

- Assessment
- Diagnosis
- Outcomes identification
- Planning
- Implementation
- Evaluation

Assessment Data

- Types of data

- Cue
- Subjective
- Objective

- Sources of data

- Primary source
- Secondary sources

- Methods of Data Collection

- Interview
- Physical exams

Patient Problem Statement

- A nursing diagnosis/patient problem statement is a type of health problem that can be identified by the nurse
 - NANDA International
 - Components
 - Patient's presenting signs and symptoms
 - Contributing, etiologic (causative), and related factors
 - Defining characteristics
 - Patient problems may be actual or potential

Other Types of Health Problems

- Collaborative problems
- Medical diagnosis
- Differentiating medical and nursing diagnoses

Goal Identification

- A goal statement indicates the degree of wellness desired, expected, or possible for the patient to achieve
- Provides a description of the specific, measurable behavior the patient will exhibit in a given time frame

Planning

- The nurse establishes priorities of care and nursing interventions are chosen that will best address the nursing diagnosis
- Information is communicated through care plan so that all health care personnel will be directly involved in the care of the patient
- The nurse decides what interventions will be effective after working with the patient and significant others

Priority Setting

- The RN must prioritize the patient problem statements according to the patient's current health status
- Physiologic needs come before safety and security
- Safety and security needs come before love and belonging needs
- Life- and health-threatening problems are ranked before other types of problems
- Actual problems may be ranked before risk problems
- Priorities change as the patient progresses in the hospitalization; as some problems are resolved, new ones can be addressed

Selecting Nursing Interventions

- Nursing interventions

- Activities that promote the achievement of the desired patient outcome
- Classified as physician-prescribed or nurse-prescribed

Writing Nursing Interventions

- Because nursing interventions in manuals and textbooks are often broad, general statements, it is often necessary to convert these into more specific, instructional statements
- Nursing interventions must be written to reduce the likelihood of misinterpretation
- Should include the subject, action verb, and qualifying details

Communicating the Nursing Care Plan

- Written nursing care plan is the product of the nursing process
- It is important to have written guidelines to promote the continuity of patient care
- Nursing care plans may be written specifically for a patient, or a nurse may use a standardized care plan for a patient

Linear Care Plans Versus Concept Maps

- Common components in the educational setting
 - NANDA-I diagnostic labels
 - Patient-centered goals and desired patient outcomes
 - Nursing interventions
 - Orders
- One of two types of care plans are noted in the educational setting
 - Care plan in a 4- or 5-column format
 - Concept map

Implementation

- Fifth phase of the nursing process
- The nurse and other members of the team put the established plan into action to promote outcome achievement
- Using evidence-based interventions, the plan is implemented in a timely and safe manner

Evaluation

- Determining the extent to which patient goals have been achieved
- Nurse takes several steps:
 - Review patient goals/desired outcomes
 - Reassess the patient for actual response to nursing interventions
 - Compare actual outcome with desired outcome and make critical judgement
- Three possible conclusions: goal was achieved, goal was not achieved, or goal was partially achieved

NANDA-I, *NIC*, *NOC*

- The NANDA-I has formed a relationship with two other groups
 - Nursing Intervention Classification (NIC) is a research group working at the University of Iowa to standardize the language used to organize and describe interventions
 - Nursing Sensitive Outcome Classification (NOC) is a research group working at the University of Iowa that has developed a standardized system to name and measure the results of patient outcomes

Role of the Licensed Practical/Vocational Nurse

- The nursing process may vary from state to state; review the state's nurse practice act
- Provide direct bedside nursing care
- This direct care position allows the LPN/LVN to closely observe, prioritize, intervene, and evaluate the care provided to and for the patient

Clinical Pathways

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- Managed care

- A health care system that has control over primary health care services and attempts to trim down health care costs by reducing unnecessary or overlapping services

- Case management

- Encompasses planning, coordination of care, and patient advocacy in providing quality, cost-effective outcomes for the patient

Clinical Pathways

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- Multidisciplinary plan that incorporates evidence-based practice guidelines for high-risk, high-volume, high-cost types of cases
- Guides care with coordination of actions from all disciplines in a health care facility
- Variance
 - Patient does not achieve the projected outcome

Critical Thinking

- Critical thinkers think with a purpose
- They question information, conclusions, and points of view
- They are logical and fair in their thinking
- Critical thinking is a complex process, and no single simple definition explains all aspects of critical thinking
- The nurse must be able not only to perform skills, but also think about what he or she is doing
- Nurses use a knowledge base to make decisions, generate new ideas, and solve

Evidence-Based Practice

- Nursing research is the basis for evidence-based practice